



ESOL Nexus professional development

Differentiating for learning in prison



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Introduction

ESOL Nexus professional development modules are intended to help teachers to develop in their role in a range of contexts. They have been written by expert practitioners and quality assured by a wider team. We hope that you will find this module useful. Further professional development opportunities can be found at

<http://esol.britishcouncil.org/content/teachers/staff-room/continuing-professional-development>

This module presents a range of approaches and strategies for differentiating for learning English in prison. Learners bring with them a variety of prior learning experiences, skills and abilities at a range of levels. ESOL learners in prison often have further issues that affect their learning. Learners with mental health issues, learning differences and disabilities are over-represented in prison compared with the general population. Moreover, the ESOL classroom in prison is often characterised by being mixed level and having a high turnover; in some there is a continual roll-on/roll-off as inmates arrive, are moved on or are deported.

This module will help you meet the challenge of teaching in this unique context and equip you with strategies for differentiating for your learners with confidence.

Using this module

- While you can work through the module at your own pace, you will find it helpful join with others to look at the content together and share your ideas.
- If you are looking at the pdf on your computer you can type your reflections into the boxes provided, and save your progress for the next time you return to the module.
- Where it says 'click for feedback', some suggested answers will appear when you click. These are not exhaustive so do explore further.



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Differentiation in prison

This step will help you to answer the following questions:

- What is differentiation and why is it important?
- What are the challenges of differentiating for ESOL learners in a prison context?
- Who are the learners?



Step 1

What is differentiation and why is it important?

- language and cultural background
- literacy levels
- educational background
- interests
- attitudes and approaches to learning
- learning differences and disabilities.



Activity 1

Consider what issues can arise from these differences, and how they affect each learner's ability to learn. Complete the table below with your thoughts.

Differences affecting how my learners learn	Issues that may arise
language and cultural background	
literacy levels	
educational background	
Interests	
attitudes to learning	
approaches to learning	
learning differences and disabilities	

What do you understand by the term 'differentiation'? Spend a few minutes thinking about this and note down your thoughts below. Then watch a video clip of a group of teachers exploring the issue of differentiation: click on this link 'Thinking about differentiation', then on the 'Putting it into practice' tab and select video one.

[illegible]

Watch video

What key aspects of differentiation do the speakers mention? Were your ideas similar? When you've finished, [click for feedback](#).

[illegible]

Activity 3

Read the definitions below and put them in order 1 - 4 with the one closest to your own view as number 1. Next consider why differentiation in ESOL in prison is so important - what are the challenges in your ESOL class?



Differentiation is the process by which differences between learners are accommodated so that all students in a group have the best possible chance of learning (Geoff Petty¹)



Differentiation is the matching of work to the differing capabilities of individuals or groups of learners in order to extend their learning. (Ofsted)



'Differentiation allows students multiple options for taking in information, making sense of ideas, and expressing what they have learned. A differentiated classroom provides different avenues to acquiring content, to processing or making sense of ideas and to developing products so that each student can learn effectively.' (Tomlinson, 2001)



...an approach to teaching that attempts to ensure that all students learn well, despite their many differences (Perry, 2003 ²)

Step 1a

¹ <http://geoffpetty.com/training-materials/differentiation/>

² D. Perry, 'Differentiation – policy and practice' (2003), Language Issues: the Journal of NATECLA, 15/1.

Differentiation in ESOL

Differentiation is about incorporating accessible and inclusive teaching and learning approaches so that all learners can succeed to the best of their ability. We differentiate learning because our learners are individuals with different learning needs, interests and motivations. 'It is not enough to be doing very well with most learners and failing a few. As teachers, we must reach all of the learners, all of the time.'³

Activity 4

How do ESOL classes compare to others with regard to differentiation?

Is it..

- A. more important?
- B. less important?
- C. of the same importance?

Note the thinking behind your reasons.

[Click for feedback](#)

³ M.Wilkins, M., Paton A. (2009), Teaching English to Speakers of Other Languages: A Teacher Education Handbook, NRDC

Learners may be used to, and expect, a teacher-led, didactic approach whereas adult ESOL programmes in the UK favour a learner-centred communicative approach, that encourages learners to interact with

each other, contribute ideas and support each other. Providing opportunities for communication and interaction is crucial in any ESOL class.

Differentiation puts the learner at the heart of the learning process.

It is not about planning separate lessons for each learner or having them work individually through

packs of worksheets, although we

may need to provide some different material or adapt core materials.



Step 1a

What are the challenges of differentiating for ESOL learners in a prison context?

ESOL teaching in a prison context brings with it many additional challenges.

- 49% of women and 23% of male prisoners in a Ministry of Justice study were assessed as suffering from anxiety and depression. This can be compared with 16% of the UK population (12% of men and 19% of women).
- 25% of women and 15% of men in prison reported symptoms indicative of psychosis. The rate among the general public is about 4%.⁴

Step 1b



⁴Ministry of Justice (2013) Gender differences in substance misuse and mental health amongst prisoners

1. What challenges does Karen identify that might impact on the teacher's ability to differentiate in class?
2. How does this compare with your own experience and are there any challenges you face that she doesn't mention?

[illegible]

Watch video

- Prison aims to rehabilitate inmates and the system itself may dictate learning outcomes. Linking rehabilitation aims and the need to succeed with language to support communication skills, workplace training and interview skills, is effective. However, restrictions on the use of ICT, the internet and other technology negatively impact on the availability of resources.
- Mental health, drug and alcohol abuse problems can affect rates of learning, concentration and ability to engage in a learning situation.
- Many ESOL learners in prison have a range of complex needs including an over proportionate percentage of learning difficulties and disabilities.

Who are the learners?

In March 2014 there were 10,649 foreign nationals (defined as non UK passport holders), from 157 countries, in prisons and detention centres in England and Wales (12% of the prison population)⁵; in Scotland about 300 of the 8,300 prison population are foreign nationals⁶. Around 21% of British nationals in prison are of minority ethnic heritage. A significant number need to learn English.

Activity 7

Read the case studies below and, from the information, suggest two or three ideas to support each learner's needs.

Can you think of a teaching strategy that might work well for each learner?



Naz is 28 years old and has a seven-year sentence. Arriving from Afghanistan, he was only in the country a few months before being sentenced. He has periods of depression that cause tiredness and a lack of concentration. His English is around Entry 1 and he is eager to gain skills to help him get work outside if allowed to remain. He worries about being deported.

Step 1c

⁵ Ministry of Justice (2014) Offender Management Statistics Bulletin April 2014

⁶ Report quoted in the Scottish Daily Express 10 April, 2013

[illegible]

Step 1c

Differentiation in practice

This step will help you to answer the following questions:

- What approaches can I use to differentiate?
- How can I differentiate speaking and listening tasks?
- How can I differentiate reading and writing tasks?

*'While there is a role for learners to work individually, especially on specific weaknesses, differentiation by progress can lead to 'death by worksheets' ... Here, the danger is that learners work in isolation from the group, concentrating on a narrow range of skills and missing out on language development gained through social interaction.'*⁷

There might appear to be a tension between group work and differentiation. Some teachers may believe the best way to meet individual needs is to give learners individual tasks, often working their way through packs of worksheets. This does not foster language development. Interaction allows learners to develop a wider range of skills and understanding; by collaborating and communicating with others, a productive group ethos can be encouraged. Research has shown that 'talk is work' in the ESOL classroom and the most important mode of learning is through group interaction and using opportunities to practise speaking and listening.⁸

Effective differentiation can allow learners to gain some control over their learning, to develop learner autonomy and to draw on their experiences and identity. This may be particularly relevant in a prison setting where the ESOL class may offer the only opportunity in the day for learners to have some control over what they are doing.

So how can you do it in practice?

⁷ Perry, 2003: 22-3

⁸ Roberts et al, 2004

What approaches can I use to differentiate?

There are five broad approaches to differentiation, which are by:

1. outcome
2. time
3. enrichment or extension activities
4. resource
5. task type

Activity 8

Match each of the terms above to its definition:

a) Learners work at their own speed to complete a task. Some will finish at the end of the time allocated while others will need additional task(s).

b) A range of resources are available for different learners (or groups of learners), appropriate for their level and needs. For example, work on a grammar point could be a card-sort activity, a listening task or a gap fill.

c) Learners do different kinds of tasks based on the same theme, for example, individuals might take different roles in a role play or have different tasks in a group brainstorm activity. Roles and tasks can be assigned to learners based on their strengths, interests or skills they need to develop.

d) Learners are set the same task but respond at different levels to open-ended activities. For example, learners can say a lot or a little, and a written task can elicit open-ended responses.

e) Learners are given further tasks to deepen their skills beyond the basic task/activity, or asked to explore a particular topic in more depth.

Step 2a

[Click for feedback](#)

Step 2a

When thinking about task design and differentiation, it can be useful to refer to Bloom's Taxonomy:

Bloom's Taxonomy is a spectrum of task difficulty. It goes from easy tasks such as recalling knowledge to harder tasks such as evaluating an argument. It deals with cognitive learning, but a similar approach can be used in other sorts of learning.

(Geoff Petty)

For more information about Bloom's Taxonomy and task design, go to [http://dspace.jorum.ac.uk/xmlui/bitstream/handle/10949/11532/data/downloads/ differentiation by task design.pdf?sequence=3](http://dspace.jorum.ac.uk/xmlui/bitstream/handle/10949/11532/data/downloads/differentiation%20by%20task%20design.pdf?sequence=3).

Teachers will also think about grouping or pairing their learners on the basis of linguistic level or strengths. Using this strategy, stronger and weaker learners may be paired together, or learners who present similar linguistic abilities are asked to work together. What other ways do you use to group learners?

Activity 9

Think of your own approaches to differentiation then listen to two prison ESOL teachers (Steve and Jane) talking about the approaches they use to differentiate in class. Make some notes while you listen.

1. Which of the above approaches do they mention?
2. Which approaches do they talk about which are not listed above?
3. Which approaches have you used?

Steve

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Listen



Listen

Jane

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[Click for feedback](#)

Step 2a

How to differentiate listening and speaking tasks?

Many ESOL classes in prison are mixed level and can range from Entry 1 to Level 2. This section focuses on how you can differentiate listening tasks. Although all learners will need to listen at the same time to a recording, you can ask them to respond in different ways and complete different tasks. Setting a pre-listening task (such as discussing the topic or pre-teaching key vocabulary) will help all the learners to activate background knowledge and prepare for listening. The first listening task should help learners 'tune in' to what they hear; therefore, setting a simple 'gist' task that all can successfully complete is a good starting point. For example, ask:

- How many people are speaking?
- What are they talking about?

Step 2b

Activity 10

Complete the following text about useful strategies by choosing from the words in the box below. the words from the box.

One way of differentiating listening is by asking specific learners to listen for the answers to specific questions, based on their levels. In this way, a weaker learner can build _____ and a stronger learner can be stretched and _____. Questioning does not have to be paper-based – it can be _____ and interactive, which can help learners with _____ needs as they do not have to write answers. Be careful that long stretches of listening do not become a _____ test!

Another useful activity is for learners to listen for _____ words and fill them in on a _____ transcript of the recording. Learners could have different _____ of the transcript with different words missing, with more _____ for higher-level learners. Or provide the _____ in a box for lower-level learners to choose from.

Replay the recording in small 'chunks' to allow learners to focus on, and practise, specific points such as key phrases, pronunciation and intonation.

gapped challenged versions confidence
oral words key literacy memory gaps

[Click for feedback](#)



Listen

Activity 11

Listen to the audio clip '**Ravi's order**'. Consider how you could use it in a lesson to meet the needs of a mixed level group of learners:

- What pre-listening task could you set?
- What gist question(s) could you ask?
- What questions/activities could you devise at E1, E2, E3 and L1/2 to focus on meaning, phonology (sounds), lexis (words/phrases) and grammar?

This image shows a full page of white paper with horizontal dashed lines, typical of primary school writing paper. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the entire width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings present.

[Click for feedback](#)

Step 2b

Speaking activities need to take account of ‘accuracy’⁹ and ‘fluency’¹⁰. Helping learners to improve pronunciation is also an important consideration. Not only is pronunciation important for comprehension, but stress and intonation can affect how second language speakers are perceived for example they could appear rude if their delivery is very different from native speakers.

Their needs will vary according to their main language. Teachers can include aspects of pronunciation in vocabulary work, e.g. by

- practising specific sounds with individual learners, and
- using visual reminders and gestures to indicate intonation.

Teacher questioning can also be tailored to individual learners: in group work, use closed questions with a restricted choice of responses with lower-level learners and more open questions with higher level learners

⁹ ability to use language correctly, without errors

¹⁰ ability to use language easily, communicate appropriately and able to express a wide range of ideas, without much mental effort

How can I differentiate reading and writing tasks?

Modifying reading texts is the principal way to adapt texts to different levels. This is usually done by:

- reducing the number of paragraphs
- increasing 'white space'
- shortening sentences
- simplifying the language
- changing the font and size of font.

There are various ways of setting reading tasks to match different levels.

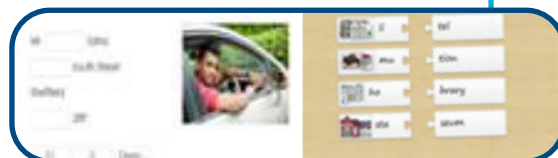
For example, you could:

- provide a grid of questions or statements for learners to complete
- provide statements and ask them to tick whether they are true or false
- use multiple-choice questions
- use question and answer in the target language
- ask learners to summarise
- ask learners to provide definitions of some of the key vocabulary
- ask learners to provide a personal response
- use visuals.

Step 2c

For lower level learners (and those with literacy needs), other tasks might include:

- word searches
- matching activities
- unjumbling phrases
- gap-filling tasks.



A lesson plan with suggestions for differentiating a reading lesson (based on museums) can be [found here](#).

Writing is a complex process which involves different cognitive and motor skills. The first parts of the process – thinking what to say and how to say it, are the most difficult and complex to teach. In prison, an additional consideration is what kind of writing the learners need to be able to do, such as fill in an app or practise writing for an exam. In general, you need to consider the following stages:

- audience and purpose of text
- content
- planning
- drafting
- editing, proof-reading and re-drafting
- producing a final version.

‘Scaffolding’, a term associated with Vygotsky’s ‘Zone of Proximal Development’¹¹, helps learners with the writing process. ESOL teachers can use scaffolding to support learners to construct meaning and knowledge by differentiating learning tasks and materials, and by providing verbal and academic supports, including peer support.

¹¹ Vygotsky, 1978 <http://www.psy.cmu.edu/~siegler/vygotsky78.pdf>

Successful scaffolding includes presenting activities in a systematic, structured way so that learners can explore topics in a supportive learning environment, through staged tasks to increase confidence and autonomy and foster independence.

To support all learners in developing their writing skills, it is helpful to break down tasks into stages using, for example, model texts, writing frames, gapped texts, and useful phrases and vocabulary.

Activity 15

Look at the strategies below. Choose the correct missing word for each one from the box. When you have finished, [Click for feedback](#)

- generating _____ for writing
- discussing, _____ and drafting
- deciding what to _____
- choosing language _____ for purpose and audience
- deciding on the level of _____ to include
- using a _____ of writing suitable for the purpose
- using correct word _____ and verb forms
- using _____ appropriately
- proof-reading for content, spelling and _____
- writing _____

suitable	style	detail	include	ideas
legibly	order	planning	accuracy	punctuation

Look at a dental app form used in your prison. The prisoner is asked: 'Please describe your dental problem in detail'. What activities/ tasks could you devise to support the learners in your group to achieve this? Which of the above strategies could you use?

[illegible]

For learners with basic literacy needs, a ‘language experience approach’, providing writing frames and gapped texts are good starting points. For further guidance read this [article](#) and work through the [CPD module](#).

Structuring differentiated learning

This step will help you to answer the following questions:

- What systems support differentiation?
- How can I plan a differentiated lesson?
- What other strategies can I use?

‘Given that learners start at different points, learn in different ways and progress at different speeds, one-size-fits-all strategies will clearly not do’¹²



Step 3

¹² Perry, 2003: 22-3

How do I plan a differentiated lesson?

When planning you need to prepare for learners in your group being transferred, often with little or no notice. Having a range of strategies and approaches in your repertoire can assist you in planning effectively and help you provide differentiated learning.

Activity 17

You are planning a session on: Keeping fit and healthy in prison. Choose four of the activities below and develop each one to produce a differentiated session on the topic. Think about how you could include a variety of resources including flashcards, film, realia, audio, written texts and so on.

- Learning resources at more than one level
- Setting a problem solving task
- Group work at different levels
- Self access materials
- Extension activities
- Writing frames at different levels
- Speaking tasks
- Listening activities



You can use some of these idea to help you:



Step 3a

Activity 18

Visuals are an ESOL teacher's flexible friends. Flashcards, small images, photographs, paintings, drawings, cartoons can be used for a variety of purposes and with learners at any level. Having an image of a word or phrase gives learners a concrete example of language they are learning. Look at the image below and think how you can use it in whole class activities and with different ability groups. Add to the boxes below with suggestions of your own.



All levels

Warmer to introduce the context or topic. Ask learners what they think the picture is about. You could nominate more proficient learners to answer first. Less proficient learners could be asked to identify specific items eg car, table.

Step 3a

Beginners Entry 1

Vocabulary building activities: matching word cards to items; verbs for actions; copying or writing the words, grammar. Stimulus for a language experience activity.

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Entry 2

Describing what they see in simple sentences: There is / are; using the present continuous; prepositions of place; questioning each other 'Where ..?; what...?

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Entry 3 and above

More complex sentences to practise grammar they are learning orally and in writing; creating captions; stimulus for creative writing; compare and contrast with another image from the topic.

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All

Role play where learners are assigned roles appropriate to their level.

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How can I manage my classroom to support differentiation?

Classroom management can help you with differentiation. Groups or pairs of learners working together provides lots of opportunities to promote rich learning experiences. In prison this can be more difficult as you need to consider the personalities in the group carefully and know who can and can't work together.

Activity 19

Think about the different ways you can group your learners to support their learning. Complete the chart below. The first grouping has been done for you.

Group	Positives	Negatives
Random selection	Easy to organise: you can do it by alphabetical order, or give learners a number 123, 123	Sometimes conflicts can arise so it is important to select learners who will work well together.
Friendships (learners choose their own groups/partners)		
Language groups (mixed or same first language)		
Ability groups (stronger learners together or weaker learners together)		
According to skill set (e.g. a strong writer with a strong speaker)		
Mixed ability pairs Age / experience		
Learning preferences		

Step 3b

What other strategies can I use?

As discussed in Steps 1 and 2 above, strategies include:

- varying the pace of the lesson according to the learners and the task
- providing tasks which are in keeping with learners' interests
- using a variety of teaching techniques
- choosing different ways to assess learners
- making sure materials are appropriate, accessible and relevant for learners.
- moving the balance of power from the teacher to the learner
- using methods to maximise participation of all learners
- adapting the level of support and challenge to individual learner needs.

Knowing your learners' individual needs is key to differentiation. All learners, in whichever prison who take part in education, will complete

- an Initial Assessment
- a Diagnostic Assessment
- an Individual Learning Plan

Activity 20

What will each kind of assessment or ILP tell you about the learner? Note down your ideas in the boxes below.

What can you find out about your learners from initial assessment?

What can you find out about your learners from diagnostic assessment?

How can ILPs help you plan learning for your different learners?

Activity 21

Think about four of your learners and their language development. Fill in the charts to show their different levels of reading, writing, speaking and listening.

Learner 1	Level	Learner 3	Level
• Speaking and listening • Reading • Writing		• Speaking and listening • Reading • Writing	
Learner 2	Level	Learner 4	Level
• Speaking and listening • Reading • Writing		• Speaking and listening • Reading • Writing	

You will see that they all have different levels of ability in different areas. These are often referred to as 'spiky profiles'. Use the information gathered from the assessments and ILPs to develop a group profile. This will help you to identify the strengths and weaknesses within the group and plan differentiated learning activities for your class.

Activity 22

Shani is joining your established group of learners who are all working at E3. Can you devise some activities to meet her needs by differentiating activities within the group? Add ideas to two of the four targets in her ILP below.

Name: Shani Mahmoud
Prison number: NVT 32008 B

Date of Interview: 3.12.13

Initial Assessment Results

Literacy/Language	Reading	Level: E1
	Spelling	Level: E1
	Punctuation	Level: E1
	Speaking	Level: E2/3
	Listening	Level: E3

Date of Assessment: 28 /06/2014

Notes on Interview and Initial Assessment

Shani has been transferred from HMP Ashwell but her last ILP has not arrived. She has completed a further I.A. She wants to improve both spoken and written English. She has been in England for 10 months but lived in Urdu-speaking community and had little opportunity to learn English. She had little formal education in Pakistan. She would like to work in the sewing workshop and is motivated to reach E3 qualifications to do this. She would like to start her own business making clothes when released in about 3 years' time.

She feels she can understand English much better than she can speak it, but isn't confident and would like to do more speaking activities. She would like support with reading and writing but finds it difficult and finds it hard to remember vocabulary.

Oral Communication Notes:

Shani lacks confidence in her speaking skills. She would like support with pronunciation. At HMP Ashwell she worked with a buddy and likes working best with one other person.

Individual Support Needs/Requirements:

Support to build confidence and become established in a new group
Spoken language development and linguistic accuracy
Help with written language, letter formation and written conventions
Reading activity from E1, simple texts and familiar vocabulary

Total number of Learning Hours for duration of ILP	90 hours
Literacy	hours
Numeracy	hours
ESOL	15 hours/week

Individual Learning Plan

Target 1

Date	Activity	Resource

Target 2

Date	Activity	Resource

A final word

We have seen that differentiation puts the learner at the heart of the teaching and learning process. Learners bring their own individual life experiences and identities into the ESOL classroom; differentiation helps to foster learner choice and ensure that each learner takes something useful away from every lesson.

- Differentiation is about more than differences in ability – there are many factors that make learners different from one another.
- Getting to know your learners helps to increase differentiation possibilities.
- You can become intuitive in differentiating – it can become a natural part of your classroom strategies.
- Don't try to differentiate at all lesson stages - do core work as a whole class, accessible to all learners and consider readiness, interest and learner profiles.
- Increase motivation in reluctant learners by considering interests and needs.
- Consider the outcomes you expect for individual learners - diagnostic assessment can help in this.
- Use extension and open-ended tasks to allow appropriate differentiation to take place.
- Provide a variety of tasks and approaches to suit learner profiles.

Differentiation is not about creating a separate lesson plan for each learner in your class. It is about ensuring that every learner can have success in their learning

Activity 23 Bringing it all together

In planning your next session think of some ways you can build in differentiation for the learners you are currently teaching. Make notes using the following headings:

Activities – how can I vary these for different levels and types of abilities?

.....

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Resources/worksheets

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.....

Timing

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.....

Pairing/grouping learners

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Additional activities

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Anything else?

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.....

Reflection

In this module you have considered differentiating for learning in prison. Now spend a short time reflecting on what you have learnt.

Stage 1: What?

Questions for you to consider:

- How much did you use differentiation strategies in your teaching before beginning this module?
- What knowledge have you gained that will have a direct impact on your classroom teaching?
- Have you discovered any specific strategies that you can use in the classroom?
- Would you like to take this subject any further? If so, what will you do?

Stage 2: So what?

Reflect by considering your thoughts and feelings about the content in the module and making some notes.

What do you feel about differentiating for learning in prison? Have there been any changes in your thinking about this topic? How will what you have learnt affect the people you teach?

Stage 3: Now what?

How can you apply what you have learnt in this module to your own teaching context?

How will you apply your learning from the module?

What will you do in the classroom that you didn't do before?

Suggested answers to activities

Activity 2

- Be aware everyone learns in a different way
- Be aware of cultural background and individual pronunciation difficulties
- Simpler activities for weaker learners
- Meet the needs of each learner
- Vary activities – address different learning preferences.

Activity 4

There is no such person as a ‘typical’ ESOL learner – they have been described as ‘super diverse’ (Came, Brough and Cooke 2002). Within one class, learners may come from very different cultural and educational backgrounds. Therefore teachers need to be more sensitive to the diversity of need within any group of learners.

Activity 5

Karen mentions these challenges:

- An oppressive and claustrophobic environment. The culture can be stressful, confusing and difficult to adjust to.
- Many struggle not only with day to day language but with the language of prisons and the legal complexities.
- Teaching sessions can be long, without a proper break.
- Lack of support for teachers in prison.
- Effect of depression or other issues on motivation.
- Prison regimes clash with educational values; it is difficult to find out about learners’ backgrounds and build rapport with them.
- Learners do not understand the legal system and prison regime. Some have completed their sentences but are still in prison as their deportation paperwork has not been completed.
- Racism and abuse.
- Typical ESOL materials may not be suitable for learners in prison.
- Clashes can occur between learners from different cultural backgrounds.
- Can’t talk about their crimes for confidentiality reasons.

Suggested answers to activities

Activity 7

Naz:

- Agree with Naz two or three short targets he can achieve quickly.
- Include short tasks, preferably work related activities, in your sessions that enable him to make visible progress in small steps.
- Include fun activities – learning games, film, and music to help him to relax and focus away from his worries.

Eva:

- Include active speaking and listening class tasks in each session and also pair and small group work with classmates.
- Focus on communication needed in prison, e.g. relevant vocabulary, pronunciation and stress patterns that sound polite, effective ways of instigating conversations.
- Give vocabulary-building activities from hairdressing topics as additional cell work.

Omar:

- Give him extra responsibility by asking him to work with designated learners who are at a lower level.
- Include structured speaking and listening activities in small groups which require turn taking and listening for detail.
- When doing whole class activities, make it clear that the only responses you will accept are from nominated learners, but make sure you nominate him when it's likely he will be able to give the right response to build his confidence.
- Remember to give him positive feedback when at the end of sessions where he's been co-operative and not attention seeking.

Activity 8

Answers: 1 d); 2 a); 3 e); 4 b); 5 c)

Suggested answers to activities

Activity 9 Differentiation Strategies

Steve	Jane
kinaesthetic activities range of different materials own culture and music build in different approaches real documents from the prison additional activity relate everything to the learners own experience and needs classroom assistants	simplify texts for E1 and E2 vary questions group according to level work with people of a similar level separate listening groups their own level and their own pace. use magnetic letters learning support assistant

Activity 10

1. confidence 2. challenged 3. oral 4. literacy 5. memory
6. key 7. gapped 8. versions 9. gaps 10. words

Activity 11

Pre-listening tasks	(a) Look at Canteen sheet and discuss what learners order and why (b) Pre-teach some key vocabulary, e.g. toiletries, mouthwash, dental floss, deodorant, depressed, etc.
Gist question (all levels)	What kind of items does Ravi want? • Toiletries • Things for washing

Suggested answers to activities

Activity 11 Continued

Possible questions E1

1. How much does Ravi earn?
£10 per week / £11 per week / £12 per week?

2. Can he save any money? *Yes / No*

3. Why does he want to keep clean?
He feels better / His friend told him he smells

4. Why does he need mouthwash?
He likes it / The dentist told him to buy some

Grammar: focus on nouns and articles 'a razor' 'a nailbrush' 'some mouthwash' 'some dental floss'.
Use sections of transcript to focus on pronunciation of key vocabulary and word stress.

Possible questions E2

As above, but without options. Additional questions (or change to True/False or multiple choice):

5. Why does he want to send things to his family?

6. Why does he need deodorant?

7. Why does he need dental floss and mouthwash?

Grammar: focus on verb 'need' and adverbials 'lately' 'sometimes' 'usually' 'last few days' 'really' 'every day'; 'going to' for future
Use sections of transcript to focus on sentence stress, e.g. 'hard to save' 'really important' 'new razor' 'I've got to' 'start flossing'; pronunciation of 'going to' – 'gonna' 'want to' – wanna.

Possible questions E3

As above, without options. Additional questions:

8. Why are toiletries important for Ravi?

9. Why does he want to have a shower every day?

10. What happened to his nailbrush?

11. Why is Ravi going to start flossing his teeth?

Grammar: focus on verb forms: 'allowed' 'not allowed' 'got to = have to' 'need'; 'going to' for future
Lexis: 'it's hard to save'; afford
Gapped transcript to focus on stressed vowel sounds/intonation patterns.

Suggested answers to activities

Activity 11 Continued

Possible questions L1/L2

Open questions to encourage discussion, e.g.

- Why does he think he will feel better if he has a shower every day?
- What did the dentist recommend Ravi does?
- Does Ravi sound happy or sad? Why do you think that is?

Grammar focus: sentence/clause structure and zero conditional 'When I keep clean ...' 'When I fill in the order sheet, I ...'; use of 'getting' (=becoming) in 'my teeth are getting bad'

Pronunciation: use gapped transcript to focus on unstressed vowel sounds, elision, linking and intonation patterns.

Activity 13

1. Role play: differentiation by task and/or outcome.
 - a. Learners take roles which provide suitable language practice for their level.
 - b. Prompts either on cards or the board can give more or less support depending on learner.
2. Discussion: differentiation by outcome and/or time.
 - a. Learners participate at their own level, and use other languages when appropriate for the task.
 - b. Use mime, images or drawings to express their ideas as in Language Experience Approach.
3. Short oral activity or game: differentiation by task, resource, outcome and/or time.
 - a. Learners are grouped in same level groups to carry out short oral tasks/ games which are carefully scaffolded (see Activity 15) for weaker learners and freer for stronger learners.
 - b. Learners grouped in mixed levels with stronger/ more confident learners reporting back to the group.

Suggested answers to activities

4. Giving a presentation: differentiation by task, resource and/or outcome.
 - a. Learners participate at their own level i.e. do shorter, simpler presentation.
 - b. Weaker learners given additional support e.g. vocabulary prompts and fixed phrases.

Activity 14 Adapting the text 'Using the library'

Adapted rewrite - suitable for Entry 3

When you join the library you can take out a maximum of three books for a period of two weeks. If you have enhanced status, you can also take out a DVD for one week.

The library is open every weekday and each level has a designated time to visit. See the timetable for details. You can return or borrow books or films at other times when the library is open.

If you cannot leave your unit, there is a mobile library that visits the levels every Wednesday with a selection of books. You can ask your Personal Officer to request this for you. Please do not lend your books and films to other people as they are your responsibility. Look after your books and return them on time.

Adapted rewrite - suitable for Entry 2

You can take out a maximum of three books for a period of two weeks. If you have enhanced status, you can also take out a DVD for one week.

The library is open every weekday and each level has a set time to visit. See the timetable for details. You can return or borrow books or films at other times too.

If you cannot leave your unit, a mobile library visits the levels on Wednesday. Ask your Personal Officer to request this for you. Please do not lend your books and films to other people as they are your responsibility. Look after your books and return them on time.

Suggested answers to activities

Adapted rewrite - suitable for Entry 1

You can borrow three books for up to two weeks.

The library is open every weekday and each level has a time to visit.
See the timetable for details.

A mobile library visits the levels on Wednesday. Ask your Personal Officer to request this for you. Please do not lend your books and films to other people. Look after your books and return them on time.

Suggested reading tasks for each level:

Original version - suitable for Level 1 and Level 2

Answer the questions:

1. How many books can you borrow and for how long?
2. Who can borrow a DVD?
3. When can you visit the library?
4. What is the purpose of a mobile library?
5. How do you get permission to use the mobile library?
6. Why can you not lend your books or films to other people?
7. In paragraph 2, what do 'designated' and 'drop in' mean?
8. Do you use the library? What kinds of books do you like reading?

Adapted rewrite - suitable for Entry 3

Read the text and decide if these questions are True or False:

- | | |
|---|-------|
| 1. You can borrow three books at a time | T / F |
| 2. Everyone can borrow a DVD | T / F |
| 3. The library is open every day | T / F |
| 4. You can only go to the library at the set time | T / F |
| 5. There is a timetable with the opening times | T / F |
| 6. The mobile library is for people who
are not able to leave their unit | T / F |
| 7. It is OK to give your books and films to other people | T / F |
| 8. You must return your books on time | T / F |
| 9. In paragraph 2,
'designated' means a) different b) specific c) early
'drop in' means a) fall down b) reduce c) visit | |

Adapted rewrite - suitable for Entry 2

Read the text and circle the correct answer:

1. You can borrow *two / three / four* books.
2. You can keep the books for *one / two / three* weeks.
3. *Some people / everyone / no-one* can borrow a DVD.
4. The library is open *Monday – Friday / Tuesday – Sunday / weekends*
5. The mobile library visits the levels on *Tuesday / Wednesday / Thursday*
6. It is *OK / not OK / fine* to lend your books to other people.

Adapted rewrite - suitable for Entry 1

Read the text and choose the correct answer:

1. How many books can you borrow *two / three*
2. How long can you keep the books? *one week / two weeks*
3. When is the library open? *Monday - Friday / weekends*
4. When does the mobile library visit? *Wednesday / Thursday*
5. Can you lend your books to other people? *Yes / No*

Activity 15 Strategies

1 ideas, 2 planning, 3 include, 4 suitable, 5 detail, 6 accuracy, 7 style, 8 order, 9 punctuation, 10 legibly

Activity 16 Differentiation in writing

- Letters and notes are ideal for differentiation as learners can write at their own level and produce authentic material.
- Differentiation can be encouraged by learners choosing their own topic and content.
- Vocabulary, phrases or model texts could be provided to support some learners.

Further reading and websites

Baynham, M. et al (2006) *ESOL Effective Practice Project*. London: NRDC

Came, F., Brough M., and Cooke, G. (2002) Learning Styles: a new look at differentiation. *Learning Works*

Convery, A. and Coyle, D. (1993) *Differentiation: Taking the Initiative*, Centre for Information on Language Teaching and Research (CILT)

Perry, D. (2003) Differentiation – policy and practice, *Language Issues*, 15(1), Summer: 22-3

Petty, G., 2011, New Learners: Getting in right from the beginning, in *Intuition* issue 6, London: Institute for Learning.

Geoff Petty's website: differentiation training materials
<http://geoffpetty.com/training-materials/differentiation/>

Roberts, C. and Baynham, M. et al (2004) *ESOL Case Studies of Provision, Learners' Needs and Resources*. London. NRDC

Weir, M. (2009) Chapter 10 'Differentiation', in *Teaching Adult ESOL, Principles and Practice*, ed. Paton & Wilkins: Open University Press

DelliCarpini, M. 'Scaffolding and Differentiating Instruction in Mixed Ability ESL Classes Using a Round Robin Activity', *The Internet TESL Journal*, Vol. XII, No. 3, March 2006

<http://iteslj.org/Techniques/DelliCarpini-RoundRobin.html>
The ideas need to be adapted for use with low level ESOL learners.

English My Way ESOL and differentiation
<http://www.englishmyway.co.uk/help/professional-development/7>

Prison provision: coping with increasing demand, NRDC, Reflect Online, Issue 10 <http://www.nrdc.org.uk/content.asp?CategoryID=1416>

Excellence Gateway website: Guide to differentiation
<http://resources4adultlearning.excellencegateway.org.uk/cpd/mfl/differentiationactivityfs.htm>

Adult ESOL core curriculum, including 'Methods and approaches' sections
<http://www.excellencegateway.org.uk/search?content=Differentiation+ESOL>

British Council ESOL Nexus website - Differentiation in the ESOL classroom
<http://esol.britishcouncil.org/content/teachers/staff-room/teaching-articles/differentiation-esol-classroom>